rejected the Treaty as discriminatory.

16. ***Comprehensive Test Ban Treaty (CTBT), 1996:*** The Treaty was opened for signature at New York on 24 September 1996 and it is yet to come into force. It bans all nuclear explosions in all environments, for military or civilian purposes. The general obligations under this treaty are contained in Article I which states that each state Party to the Treaty must ensure that it does not carry out any nuclear weapon test explosion or any other nuclear explosion, and must take steps to prohibit and prevent any such nuclear explosion at any place under its jurisdiction or control. The state Parties must also refrain from causing, encouraging, or in any way participating in the carrying out of any nuclear weapon tests explosion or any other nuclear explosion.

Seventy-one states, including five of the eight the then nuclear-capable states signed the Treaty. At present, the CTBT has been signed by 180 states and ratified by 145 states. India, Pakistan and the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (North Korea) did not sign. In fact, India and Pakistan conducted back-to-back nuclear tests in 1998, while North Korea withdrew from the NPT in 2003 and tested a nuclear device in 2006.

17. ***Landmines Ban Treaty, 1997:*** The Treaty was formally signed in Ottawa in December 1997 and entered into force on 1 March 1999.

The general obligations under this Treaty embody that each state Party undertakes never, under any circumstances to:

(a) Use anti-personnel mines.

(b) Develop, produce, otherwise acquire, stockpile, retain or transfer to anyone, directly or indirectly, anti-personnel mines.

(c) Assist, encourage or induce, in any way, anyone to engage in any activity prohibited to a state Party under this Convention. Each state Party must also undertake to destroy or ensure the destruction of all anti-personnel mines in accordance with the provisions of this Convention.

Unfortunately, the major landmine-producing and user countries of the world such as China, India and Russia are non-signatories to the